

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 1/12: Peninsular chronology and political geography

c. 535 CE -> independent Badami Chalukya power consolidates
late 6th c. -> Simhavishnu renews Pallava expansion
early 7th c. -> Mahendravarman I and Pulakeshin II
c. 630s -> Narmada check on Harsha
c. 642 -> Narasimhavarman I captures Vatapi
8th c. -> Vikramaditya II, Rajasimha legacy and mature temple patronage
757 -> Rashtrakutas end Badami line; Pallavas survive to c. 893.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 2/12: Evidence and source criticism matrix

AIHOLE PRASHASTI -> genealogy and campaigns | royal exaggeration

PALLAVA CHARTERS -> grants and legitimation | formulaic claims

SANSKRIT + TAMIL EPIGRAPHY -> praise and documentary practice

MONUMENTS -> patronage, technique and cult | attribution limits

LITERATURE -> court, satire and devotion | genre and redaction

PORT / SETTLEMENT ARCHAEOLOGY -> exchange | uneven survival

RULE: monument first, style label later; inscription data plus ideology.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 3/12: Pallava and Chalukya ruler ladders

PALLAVA	CHALUKYA OF BADAMI
Simhavishnu	Pulakeshin I
Mahendravarman I	Kirtivarman I
Narasimhavarman I Mamalla	Mangalesha
Paramesvaravarman I	Pulakeshin II
Narasimhavarman II Rajasimha	Vikramaditya I / II
Nandivarman line	fall to Rashtrakutas
ANCHORS: Kanchi-Mamallapuram Vatapi-Aihole-Pattadakal.	

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 4/12: Kanchi-Vatapi rivalry and regional effects

KANCHI <-> VENGI / DECCAN ROUTES <-> VATAPI

|

Pulakeshin II expands east and checks Harsha

|

Mahendravarman-Pulakeshin conflict

|

Narasimhavarman I captures Vatapi -> Vatapikonda memory

|

later Chalukya victories at Kanchi -> Virupaksha commemoration

RESULT: rivalry reshaped frontiers, branches, prestige and sacred landscapes.

ASCHII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 5/12: Administration and local institutions

KING / COURT / MILITARY ELITE

- > territorial officers and revenue rights
- > grants to Brahmanas and religious institutions
- > ur: peasant village
- > sabha: Brahmana assembly in grant village
- > nagaram: merchant-linked settlement
- > mahajana: prominent village elders in Chalukya records

CAUTION: do not project mature later Chola committee detail backward.

ASCHII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 6/12: Land grants and Brahmanization

ROYAL CHARTER -> brahmadeya / agrahara

- > revenue rights + exemptions + jurisdiction
- > donee insertion into settled or expanding agrarian zones
- > cultivation + Sanskritic legitimacy + caste ordering
- > reciprocal reshaping of local cults and Brahmanical practice

USEFUL MODEL: integration and hierarchy together

LIMIT: not every grant created a new village or proved royal weakness.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 7/12: Bhakti and religious plurality

ALVARS -> Vaishnava hymns, shrine routes and emotional devotion

NAYANARS -> Shaiva hymns, sacred places and community memory

TEMPLES -> ritual + landed patronage + political visibility

JAIN / BUDDHIST GROUPS -> continued debate, institutions and court presence

INCLUSION STORIES -> Nandanar, Tiruppan Alvar and Andal

LIMIT: devotional access did not abolish caste, patriarchy or elite power

VERDICT: vernacular opening within a hierarchical religious field.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 8/12: Pallava architecture trajectory

MAHENDRAVARMAN I -> rock-cut caves: Mandagapattu, Mamandur

NARASIMHAVARMAN I -> Mamallapuram rathas and great reliefs

RAJASIMHA -> Shore Temple + Kailasanatha structural phase

LATER PALLAVAS -> Vaikuntha Perumal and continuing Kanchi patronage

TECHNIQUE: cave -> monolith -> structural temple, with overlap

MEANING: ritual experiment + royal image + coastal sacred landscape

RULE: sequence is analytical, not a crude progress ladder.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 9/12: Chalukya architecture and Vesara caution

AIHOLE -> varied structural experiments and plans

BADAMI -> caves, capital landscape and early structural work

PATTADAKAL -> northern and southern superstructure forms side by side

VIRUPAKSHA -> Dravida form, Lokmahadevi and victory memory

PAPANATHA -> comparison point for mixed formal vocabulary

DURGA TEMPLE -> apsidal plan; name does not prove Durga dedication

VESARA: modern shorthand only after site-specific description.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 10/12: Art, literature and bilingual court culture

SCULPTURE / RELIEF -> Somaskanda, Shaiva-Vaishnava programmes

PAINTING -> Badami evidence with survival and attribution limits

SANSKRIT -> prashasti, court literature and Mattavilasa-prahasana

TAMIL -> documentary epigraphy and devotional hymn worlds

DANDIN / NANDIKKALAMBAKAM -> literary memory with context cautions

MONUMENT + TEXT -> kingship communicated through several media

2024 GS-I ROUTE: art and literature must appear together.

ASCHII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 11/12: Economy, ports and Bay of Bengal links

AGRARIAN SETTLEMENTS -> surplus + taxes + temple support

CRAFT CENTRES -> weaving, metal, sculpture and building labour

KANCHI -> political, religious, literary and commercial centre

MAMALLAPURAM -> coastal outlet and port-hinterland connection

MERCHANT GROUPS / NAGARAMS -> inland and maritime circulation

BAY OF BENGAL -> exchange and cultural contact

LIMIT: maritime connectivity is not proof of a Pallava overseas empire.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 12/12: Peninsular regionalisation answer spine

OPEN -> c. 550-900 as a formative early-medieval transition

POLITY -> Pallava-Chalukya rivalry + Vengi consequence

LOCALITY -> grants + ur/sabha/nagaram + hierarchy

RELIGION -> bhakti + Jain/Buddhist plurality + social limits

ART -> named Pallava and Chalukya sites before style labels

ECONOMY -> Kanchi-Mamallapuram and selective maritime vitality

CLOSE -> rivalry, land, shrines and language rooted regional states.